



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's start the day with a quick meeting.



Learning Outcome

Accurately use important information about people's jobs and places of work in communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- Has someone refused a request you made? How did you feel?
- How would you refuse someone's request politely?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about jobs and work.
- I can refuse offers politely.
- I can describe actions that are still happening or stopped recently.





Let's Explore!

Did Farmani **grant*** Polygon their extension?

* To "grant" means to give someone something they have asked for.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Janet: Hi, Miranda. Let's keep this meeting fairly brief. What was the outcome of your meeting with Farmani?

Miranda: Encouraging. Farmani has agreed to give us an extension until Friday.

Janet: Good work. You must have impressed him.

Miranda: I believe it's a good sign that we have his confidence.

Janet: Sorry, but I wouldn't bank on it until he has approved the proposal. Well, we have work to do!

Miranda: Yes, but first I have a request.

Janet: Shoot.

Miranda: Peter has requested the week off, if that's alright.

Janet: Could you elaborate? This sounds more like Peter's request than your own.

Miranda: You are right. It is Peter's request due to some family demands. However, it doesn't sound like there's an emergency.

Janet: I'm afraid we have to decline his request. This is a very critical time. Are we in agreement?

Miranda: Yes. I strongly disagree myself. Your refusal has made my job easier.

Janet: Glad to help. Next on the agenda: When do we see Ferdinand?

Miranda: After lunch, if that's alright. Ferdinand sounds ready and eager.

Janet: That's what I like to hear! 12:30 then?

Miranda: Actually, 1:00 would be more convenient. I have a conference call over lunch.

Janet: 1:30 sharp then.

Miranda: I'll let him know. Any other business?

Janet: No. Have a good morning.

Miranda: You too.



Let's Practice!

Miranda shares the news with Janet!

Instructions: Read the sentences. Circle the correct option.

- 1) Polygon has been granted a critical _____.
(time / extension / sign)
- 2) I believe it's _____.
(a bad time / a good sign / in the loop)
- 3) I wouldn't a. _____ until he has
b. _____ the proposal.
a. (bank on it / make it / more time)
b. (granted / approved / declined)
- 4) I'm afraid we have to a. _____ his
request. This is a very b. _____. Are
we in agreement?
a. (accept / refuse / decline)
b. (limited time / less time / critical time)
- 5) It doesn't sound like there's an
_____.
(extension / envelope / emergency)



Let's Practice!

Does Janet accept or refuse the offer?

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- 1) thanks / asking / No / but / , / for
_____.
- 2) request / to / we / his / decline /
have / I'm / afraid
_____.
- 3) myself / strongly / I / disagreed
_____.
- 4) more / , / 1:00 / convenient / be /
would / Actually
_____.
- 5) Sorry / afraid / I'm / can't / I
_____.





Extension Activity

Let's talk about your experiences!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write down 5 new things you have experienced in the last year.
- Write down 5 things you have stopped doing in the last 5 years.
- Remember to use the Present Perfect tense in your sentences.
- Read your 10 sentences to your partner. Ask them about their experiences.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write about my life experiences.

☐ ☐

I write about things that have happened.

☐ ☐

I listen to my partner talk about their experiences.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **extension** (noun): extra time given for something
e.g. Our client has agreed to give us an extension on the proposal until Friday.
- **good sign** (expression): used to say an action or event shows that something else will happen
e.g. I believe it's a good sign that we have his confidence.
- **wouldn't bank on it** (expression): not depending on something
e.g. I wouldn't bank on his confidence until he has approved the proposal.
- **emergency** (noun): an immediate and unexpected situation that needs attention
e.g. It doesn't sound like there's an emergency.
- **critical time** (expression): a period of time that is very important because it influences the future
e.g. This is a critical time because we must complete the proposal by Friday.





Learning Points

Refusing Offers Politely

In the business world, social interactions such as making an offer is common. However, refusing an offer without sounding too abrupt or impolite can be challenging. How do you say "no" politely without upsetting a co-worker or your manager? Here are some phrases:

Phrases	Verb Form	Example
• <i>I'm afraid I ...</i>	• base form of the verb	<i>I'm afraid I have to decline his request.</i>
• <i>Sorry, but I don't particularly like ...</i>	• use "-ing" with 'like' in the Present Simple	<i>Sorry, but I don't particularly like declining his request.</i>
• <i>I'd really rather not ...</i>	• Use the base form of the verb without 'to' with 'rather'.	<i>I'd really rather not decline his request.</i>
• <i>I have to refuse ...</i>	• use 'to + verb'	<i>I have to refuse to accept his request.</i>
• <i>I strongly disagree/ disagreed myself.</i> • <i>No, but thanks for asking.</i> • <i>Sorry, but I wouldn't bank on it.</i> • <i>Actually ...</i>	• These are phrases you could just use when saying "no".	

Examples:

- **Clint:** *I would like to ask for a day off next week.*
- **Heidi:** ***I'm afraid I*** *can't let you take any time off.*
- **Clint:** *I feel it's better if we meet at 12 p.m.*
- **Heidi:** ***Actually,*** *12:30 would be more convenient.*





Learning Points

Using the Present Perfect Tense

The **Present Perfect** is often described as a mixture of the past and the present. It is used to talk about an action that happened in the past, or started in the past, but has a relationship to the present situation.

- *Our boss has agreed to give us an extension on the report.*

In this example, the boss agreed to give an extension in the past, but we don't know when that happened. The exact time is not important, but the consequence in the present is that there is more time to work on the report.

FORM:

subject	+	have / has	+	past participle
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In spoken English, these are the top 10 verbs most frequently used in the **Present Perfect**.

have/has	1. been 2. had 3. done 4. made 5. seen 6. come 7. become 8. gone 9. said 10. taken
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Examples:

- *You have really impressed our client.*
- *You have made my job easier.*
- *Peter has asked for a week off.*

